

company. They are like covert operatives working behind the scenes to find you the best deal, and they're FREE. Pretty cool, right?

Because these agents do all the legwork for you, you don't have to spend time gathering quotes by yourself, comparing coverage, and navigating uncharted insurance territory where nothing makes sense to those of us not trained in this area. This saves homeowners a lot of time, money, and headaches in the long run!

READER TIP:

The best way to find an agent you can trust is by word-of-mouth, so ask your friends who they use and recommend.

[TrustedChoice.com/Find-an-Agent](https://www.TrustedChoice.com/Find-an-Agent) and [DaveRamsey.com/ELP](https://www.DaveRamsey.com/ELP) are great sites to connect with a provider who is trained to find you the best coverage possible. We went with an independent agent and reduced our current policy by half. That, in turn, reduced our mortgage by half! It took a little effort but will save us \$5,000 a year.

—Kathy, CA

3. CHOOSE A HIGH DEDUCTIBLE

A high deductible policy almost always results in a lower out-of-pocket premium; however, it also means you pay a higher amount if damage or theft were to happen to your home. It's a risky move with pros and cons on either side, but could potentially save you hundreds, if not thousands, of dollars in the long run.

Before you get too excited and call your insurance agent, you need to be positive this is the best move for you, your family, and the area you live in. If your location frequently has hurricanes, tornadoes, earthquakes, and/or wildfires, a higher deductible might not be the smartest decision. You should also have an Emergency Fund in place to cover the cost of the deductible, in case you ever *did* file a claim. You don't want to create even more financial strain on you and your family because you didn't have enough to meet it.